

SEASON 01 EPISODE 05

Eve of Election

A quiet city.

LOUIS (O.S.)
In 2020, three candidates ran for
presidency. Talens was split in
half.

Empty streets. A battleground.

A door to a restaurant, Grillzy's, OPENS.

LOUIS- a grizzly bear- tall, high school grad, walks out
in a RED APRON.

LOUIS (O.S.)
My turn.

Louis heads west.

LOUIS (O.S.)
Bullock is the conservative
president of Mainland Mammalia.

TVs on SALE. The PIE CHART of animal salaries, distributed
by species.

Louis walks by the TVs. President Bullock is on them,
speaking at a rally.

LOUIS (O.S.)
A year before his first term, he
worked with the senate to pass a
bill that would boost bovine and
canine salaries.

The votes tally. The bill passes.

Louis walks by a sign, with a RED X over DOGS, DEER, OX.

LOUIS (O.S.)
Dogs, deer, ox...

A white-collar office.

LOUIS (O.S.)
While neglecting the salaries of
those on the extremes.

Louis picks up the sign. Throws it in the trash.

LOUIS (O.S.)
Bears, rabbits, raccoons...

2 EXT. OUTSKIRTS - DAY**2**

Louis crosses into the empty outskirts.

The wind blows.

He sits.

LOUIS (O.S.)
When he was elected four years ago,
he promised to reward efficiency.

Louis takes off his hat.

LOUIS (O.S.)
To skyrocket efficiency.

Louis takes off his apron.

LOUIS (O.S.)
I guess he had a certain agenda for
which species he considered more
efficient than others.

Louis stares at the tacky logo.

A painting:

OF LARGE AND SMALL ANIMALS. Blue collar workers.

OF MEDIUM ANIMALS. White collar workers.

LOUIS (O.S.)
Though the salary bill was never
meant to be touched... The
government finds ways.

A debate on TV. A YOUNGER LOUIS watches from the kitchen.

The Louis who just started high school.

3 EXT. ADELINE RALLY - DAY**3**

LOUIS (O.S.)
Adeline, the reformist candidate,
claims she'll fix this.
(a beat)
She says that in her term, she'll
re-propose the bill, make it fair.
For everyone.

Adeline at a rally.

LOUIS (O.S.)
She campaigned welfare. But unlike
Bullock, who'd spent his entire
career in the government...

An empty stage.

LOUIS (O.S.)
Adeline had a prior history of being
a performer.

A news article of quotes from her old career:
- Elite avian denounces mammalian government
- Adeline declines to speak up on reptilian negotiations
- Singer-songwriter switches to politics- why the pivot?

LOUIS (O.S.)
So when she went into politics...
Smear campaigning against her was a
piece of cake.

4 EXT. GURNICK RALLY - DAY

4

LOUIS (O.S.)
Gurnick was the final candidate. But
he didn't quite fit his party.
(sighs)
A dog with a cybernetic implant,
running for pro-green over
pro-conservative policies.

An image of a dog- GURNICK- with a strange, cybernetic
helmet.

LOUIS (O.S.)
Lot of people thought his campaign
was a mess. Except for some in the
rural areas.

Forests, landfills, areas in dire need of natural support,
being neglected.

5 EXT. OUTSKIRTS - DAY

5

Louis blinks at the yellowed grass, detached.

He gets up, walks home.

LOUIS (O.S.)
In a zero sum game-

Louis tosses foliage out of the way.

LOUIS (O.S.)
No one loses-

Louis disappears.

LOUIS (O.S.)
And no one wins.

The wind blows, but in reverse. The days pass by in reverse.

Cymbal swell, swell, until-

6 INT. EVE'S HOME - DAY

6

A rabbit- EVE- scribbles notes in a notebook.

Orange light strikes the table.

The door BURSTS OPEN. ERNIE, her sister, drops a meal off at the table.

ERNIE

You still listen to her?

Eve pauses. It's an old video of Adeline.

EVE

Yeah. During school, sometimes.

ERNIE

Don't! Don't play that video during school! It could be controversial.

EVE

(mumbles)

Ernie, what's the point of going to high school if I'm just gonna get criticized for what I listen to and watch?

ERNIE

You go to make friends.

EVE

I have friends. I should be able to play this song however I please.

ERNIE

Well do they criticize you?

EVE

No.

Ernie pauses, for a moment reconsidering-

But she continues putting things away.

ERNIE

Don't.

Eve rolls her eyes.

7 **EXT. WESTSIDE - DAY**

7

Eve crosses the street. A LOUD TRUCK passes by, playing loud music.

Eve grunts. She pulls down her ears...

8 **INT. CLASSROOM - DAY**

8

Then loosens her grip.

Eve listens to Adeline, comforted, before school begins.

Another rabbit- HARLEY- sits next to her, watching her listen.

HARLEY

Put that away!

EVE

You don't know me. You don't tell me what to do.

HARLEY

Well, guess what today's lesson is on?

The BELL RINGS. Harley turns around.

Eve glances at the corner.

The teacher enters her desk. On the news, the debates are playing LOUD AND CLEAR.

TEACHER

Okay, kids! We're gonna talk about something very relevant to what's happening on the news!

LOUIS and JUNIPER- a bear and a dog, Eve's friends across the room- glance at the board.

So do PETUNIA and ROSALINE- a beaver and otter, part of their group.

TEACHER

As you all may know, Adeline is running for president. She, like many, belongs to a socio-phylogenetic group we refer to as "avians..."

The kids begin writing. Louis scribbles in his notebook.

TEACHER

Us ourselves "mammalians," and off the coast-

The teacher points on the map-

TEACHER
"Reptilians," which we'll get to in
Unit 5...

The classroom groans.

Harley turns around and whispers to her friend.

HARLEY
This chapter is always so annoying.

FRIEND
There's always that one fatass who
brings out a historical fact no one
cares about.

Eve tries to concentrate. Her eyes flip back and forth
between the screen and Harley.

HARLEY
Mind your own business.

EVE
I'm trying, you loud bitch.

Harley's eyes widen.

HARLEY
Don't call me a bitch-

Shh! A kid shushes Harley.

TEACHER
(snaps)
Focus! Now, avians have their
history in mammalia, and what we'll
talk about in Unit 4- again, this is
an overview- is that avians have
been-
(slowly)
-culturally supplanting-
(normal speed)
mammalia in the past century.

Eve nearly rolls her eyes, but a kid raises her hand. The
teacher points.

STUDENT
"Culturally supplant," what does
that mean?

TEACHER
It's a fancy way of saying they're
trying to work their way into our
(MORE)

TEACHER (CONT'D)
government, into our policies,
eventually into our schools,
classrooms...

Next slide. ADELINE appears onscreen.

TEACHER
Many are skeptical, they think
avians have a long-form plan to
overtake our government, and lead
it-

An image of avians in high-ranking positions of
government.

The students' eyes narrow in suspicion.

TEACHER
But others think that avians'
intentions are harmless and that
they simply want a stake in
mammalian culture and way of life.

An image of avians partaking in cultural events and
sharing with mammalian culture.

Eve's face softens.

TEACHER
Anyway, the big idea we'll be
learning in *this* unit is that
avians, like many societies, embrace
and enforce democracy, so free
voting, elections, that thing-

She flips slides.

TEACHER
But they also have an implicit caste
system where avians are ranked based
on social system, and those ranked
lower often receive fewer social
benefits and are often seen as
disposable.

She flips through several slides. The caste system shown
onscreen. Avians getting tortured, taken advantage of,
feathers on streets.

What progress the class made drops. People's eyes glance
away in disgust. Petunia grips her arm. Rosaline frowns.

Juniper stares on, as if he'd already heard this before.

TEACHER

In the next few months, we'll be learning about avians, how they benefit our country, and how we benefit them.

Louis writes. A little too hard. His pencil breaks.

He stares at his pencil. He frowns.

Juniper turns around and hands him lead.

JUNIPER

(whispering)

Thank me later.

Louis smiles.

THE BELL RINGS.

9 EXT. CAFETERIA - DAY

9

Two big animals fighting now.

CROWD

Fight! Fight! Fight!

10 INT. CAFETERIA - DAY

10

Eve sits with the group.

She brings out her phone- but pauses. She leans on her chin.

PETUNIA

Hey, bigbacks.

LOUIS

Dude, holy shit, I was gonna fall asleep in class-

PETUNIA

Guess this is what sophomore year's like.

ROSALINE

It's not *that* bad.

JUNIPER

Only 30 hours of studying a week, about birds.

LOUIS

Why are they so important, anyway?

Juniper takes out his lunchpail of premade food. He tries to offer, but Louis shakes his head.

ROSALINE
You weren't listening?

LOUIS
I was, just don't understand why
she's rushing through the unit.

ROSALINE
'Cause an avian's in the race.

LOUIS
Yeah, but why isn't, say, a reptile
running? I don't get it.

EVE
You should pay attention to the news
more, the stuff they don't teach
in school. Then you'll get it.

The group looks at Eve. She perks up.

EVE
Anyway. Don't know.

Louis rubs his arm, glances off.

Petunia and Rosaline raise eyebrows at Juniper.

JUNIPER
Hey! Can we just eat lunch like
normal? Nor-mal?

The group rolls their eyes, dig in.

11 **EXT. CAFETERIA - DAY**

11

The day's over. Louis leaves the cafeteria with Juniper.

The three girls sit on a ledge, watching them go.

Rosaline breaks off first.

ROSALINE
I'm busy! See you!

Petunia waves. She turns to Eve.

PETUNIA
Hey, spit it. What's going on?

Eve crosses her arms.

She leans forward.

EVE
Promise you won't tell anyone?

Petunia nods.

EVE
I'm homeschooled. I've been
homeschooled way up until high
school.

Rosaline glances at Eve.

PETUNIA
(surprised)
Really?

EVE
My sister, I don't know, she...
handles everything.

ROSALINE
What about your parents?

Eve glances down at the ground.

Rosaline leans back.

ROSALINE
Ah...

EVE
You?

12 EXT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

12

The duo walks out of the gates, holding hands affectionately.

PETUNIA
I live with my auntie. Rosaline's a
family friend. We're not related by
blood, obviously, but we're really
close.

She crosses her fingers to signify it.

EVE
See, I'm related to my sister by
blood, but it's like we barely talk.
She gets home at 7PM from work,
argues with me, and just knocks out.

PETUNIA
Sounds boring.

EVE
'Cause it is.

The two cross downtown. It's clean.

EVE

We used to sing together. Back when
I was 5.

They look both ways, cross the street.

EVE

We used to sing Adeline's songs.
That was way before she became a
politician.

The girls finish crossing. On hearing what Eve thinks,
they sit.

PETUNIA

Here.

Eve tenses up, but sits. She fumbles with her rings.

EVE

I don't know...

Petunia leans in and hugs her. Eve tries to come up with
something, but sighs.

She leans in and hugs back.

EVE

It feels like everything is
happening, but nothing at the same
time.

She leans back into Petunia's arms. Then they break apart.

EVE

Wanna know something cool?

PETUNIA

It better be cool.

Eve smiles.

13 EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY

13

Eve crosses.

Petunia hesitates- but follows.

14 INT. EVE'S HOME - DAY

14

The door opens.

EVE

Can you help me with my math
homework, by the way?

Petunia glances around, eyes wide, at the home. Ceiling is cracked, and yellow popcorn is peeling off.

PETUNIA

Sure!

The two girls unload their homework on the counter. Eve brings out her notebook.

Eve grabs a guitar and sits. She strums it. Then plays Adeline's music. It's beautiful.

She hands Petunia the guitar.

Petunia fake-plays. She chuckles, laughs. Eve laughs with her. They strum fake tunes. Their laughter fades into:

Eve showing Petunia her bedroom.

Petunia feels all her homeschooled books, some history, some linguistics...

A family photo remains tucked away.

15 EXT. EVE'S HOME - DAY

15

With the sun beginning to set, Petunia waves Eve goodbye.

For the first time, she glances not at the street in front of her, but at the hill across the tracks.

The hill with all the richer homes.

She holds her glance, then leaves.

16 INT. EVE'S HOME - NIGHT

16

Ernie heads inside, unpacking, exhausted.

She leaves the meal for Eve without talking-

Then hides back in her bedroom.

Eve glances at her math homework- it's complete.

But the moment of hope-

17 EXT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

17

Is taken away with her phone, after school.

Eve is sitting in the classroom. Harley has her phone, and is showing Adeline to Eve.

It's a Tuesday on the calendar.

HARLEY

No one wants to listen to this shit.

Harley CHUCKS the phone back at Eve. Eve catches it.

Harley walks away. The door closes.

18 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

18

Louis arrives.

There's a bin labeled TO BE UPCYCLED.

It's full of fur.

He uses his hand to dish out as much water as he can.

Washes the rest of the fur off. It's a mix of brown, white, tan, black fur...

The door WHAMS open. Louis whirls toward the door.

HAZEL

(cooing)

Fuck you, bitch!

SIENNA

Nah, fuck you!

Louis peeks around the corner. His sister and Sienna are kissing, feeling each other up.

SIENNA

H-hey!

Louis ducks inside the restroom. He locks the door.

Hazel turns the knob.

HAZEL

Open up!

LOUIS

I'm telling Mom!

HAZEL

Open up, bitchass! Shouldn't you be whining about politics to your friends after school?

LOUIS

I'm not whining about shit! Get away from me!

Hazel BANGS on the door. Then Louis hears a muffled SLAM.

Louis quietly opens the bathroom door. He hears Hazel and Sienna making out. The sound is muffled.

Louis covers his ears. He leaves with his hoodie on.

19 EXT. DOWNTOWN - NIGHT

19

Louis brings out his phone. He thinks of who to call. He scrolls- but doesn't find what he's looking for.

But he stops. He hears yelling. He hears a crowd yelling.

BEAR
Fuck Bullock!

DOG
Fuck Adeline!

He realizes he's at the collision point of two entire protests.

20 INT. JUNIPER'S HOME - NIGHT

20

Juniper is eating cereal in the background.

JANE, his mother, watches the protests on the news. She cups her mouth. Her breathing grows quicker, then she changes the channels-

To the debates.

Juniper, paused- continues eating.

BULLOCK
I will continue to uphold my
promise. To reward efficiency, and
to give you a truly hardworking
country where the stragglers are
out!

The crowd yells.

Jane stares, intent.

SEYMOUR, his father, heads downstairs.

SEYMOUR
(sighs)
Halcyon, darling?

JANE
What else would I be watching?

Seymour and Jane jump on the couch and kiss. On the news is a logo of a BOLD RED H.

Subheaded for HALCYON NEWS.

Seymour sighs. It's Adeline's turn to speak.

ADELINE

Who is he talking about, when almost 30% of our jobs are taken by so-called stragglers, when 30% of our consumer economy is taken by so-called stragglers! Large and small animals who will fill the roles no other mammal is brave enough to fulfill!

The crowd roars. Some boo.

BULLOCK

And you'd trust an avian over your own people?

JANE

Yes. Yes!

The crowd roars.

ADELINE

An avian like me will fight for more than many in this country ever will!

JANE

(chuckles)

Absolutely not. Hypocrites. Bunch of hypocrites.

The crowd roars- again, more boos.

JANE

See? Even the crowd's listening to me.

The door opens.

SEYMOUR

Laurel! John! We're on the primaries!

LAUREL (O.S.)

Adeline loses the election by a slim margin, 50-50, swings'll go for Bullock! That's my take!

SEYMOUR

Lousy take! Bullock wins this!

JOHN

You guys are treating politics like it's sports.

John appears in the kitchen.

JOHN

Hey, June.

Juniper nods. Fist-bumps John. John dashes upstairs and SLAMS the door.

Laurel appears next. She jumps on the couch.

LAUREL

What's his problem?

SEYMOUR

Just leave him alone. He'll come to.

Juniper stares down at his food. He places it in the sink.

SEYMOUR

Upupup! Wash it!

Juniper groans, washes the dishes.

LAUREL

Why don't you come sit with us?

Juniper glances up.

His entire family is staring him down. Minus John.

JUNIPER

I have... homework.

The stare lasts just a bit longer. Jane breaks it.

JANE

Well, you heard him, he has homework.

The family laughs him off. Seymour wipes his nose.

Juniper leaves the bowl dripping on the rack. He dashes upstairs.

On the way, he passes by his family portrait. His mother, his father, him, his sister... And John.

We know everyone now.

Juniper heads into the upstairs hallway.

He presses his ear to John's room.

JOHN (O.S.)

Yeah, I don't know bruh... They look at me like I'm a monster, then deny it when I call it out? Literally. I don't even fucking know anymore.

Juniper knocks.

JOHN (O.S.)
Yes, Dad?!

Downstairs: The family hears it. Seymour takes a deep breath, lets out a tense, righteous sigh.

JUNIPER
June! It's June!

JOHN
Juniper opens the door.

JOHN
What's up, June?

JUNIPER
You good?

John pauses for a bit. His entire room's a mess.

JOHN
Yeah.
(smiles)
Just talking on the phone.

Juniper nods, heads to his room. He gets out his phone-
But doesn't find Louis's number.

21 EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY 21

Louis and Eve cross the tracks.

22 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY 22

Juniper, Petunia, and Rosaline pass by in cars.

23 EXT. TRACK - DAY 23

The kids are doing their fitness test, running on the tracks.

Juniper passes Louis.

LOUIS
(panting)
Fuck you!

Juniper laughs.

24 INT. LOCKER ROOM - DAY 24

Juniper changes. He takes a swipe at Louis's body.

Louis, at a different time, does the same.

25 EXT. LOCKER ROOM - DAY**25**

All the kids wait for the bell to ring. Louis holds out his phone.

LOUIS
Hey, June? I just wanted to... uh, I kinda was working on some homework and-

Louis brings out his phone.

LOUIS
I need help on some stuff. Kinda. Maybe.

June pauses, then realizes-

He perks up a little too quickly.

JUNIPER
Yeah! Me too, I also need help on like, some practice problems. For the SAT.

Juniper stares at Louis's phone, zoning out, in his head. Suddenly he snaps to.

He writes his number.

412-376...

7135.

Louis stares at it, his hand shaking.

LOUIS
Cool.

Louis holds out his hand and fist-bumps Juniper.

The bell rings.

26 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY**26**

The group hangs out downtown.

They grab snacks, items, things.

Louis and Juniper break off first, heading to Louis's house.

Eve, Petunia, and Rosaline wait for a bit, then head to Eve's house.

27 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT**27**

Louis welcomes Juniper inside.

LOUIS
This is my humble abode.

Juniper glances around at the furniture, the dust, the TUB named UPCYCLED.

Louis pushes it to the bathroom.

LOUIS
Fuck, forgot to throw this one
away...

Juniper chuckles.

LOUIS
Wanna uh- wait, wanna come with me
to the grocery store?

28 INT. GROCERY STORE - DAY**28**

At the corner store, Louis picks out a group of carrots, then lettuce, then halibut.

29 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT**29**

Louis cooks for Juniper, glancing at the front door frantically as he goes.

JUNIPER
You gonna start on your homework
soon?

Louis plates the halibut.

LOUIS
Have some.

Juniper blinks.

JUNIPER
Really?

LOUIS
Have some, bitchass, before I change
my mind.

Juniper smiles, takes a bite.

In the house, water drips from the faucet.

A portrait looks crooked.

The TV looks dusty.

But Louis takes a deep breath, and sighs.

LOUIS
Been a while since you've been here,
huh?

Juniper nods.

JUNIPER
Looks old.

LOUIS
Fuck you.

Juniper smiles.

LOUIS
This is my way of paying you back
for feeding me during lunch. Now
we're even.

Juniper eats a piece, then rips through it. Louis breathes nervously.

JUNIPER
This is you? This is your cooking?

Louis shrugs, nonchalant, though a small smirk slides out.

JUNIPER
You should become a chef or
something.

LOUIS
Ah, now you're just beating a dead
horse.

JUNIPER
I'm not beating a dead horse, I'm
telling you the truth.

LOUIS
Fuck you.

JUNIPER
Fuck you! Is your response to
everything "fuck you?"

LOUIS
Fuck you!

JUNIPER
Huh? As I was saying?

LOUIS
Fuck you!

The boys laugh, until-

The door suddenly unlocks.

Louis JOLTS up. He grabs Juniper and whisks him to the bedroom.

LOUIS
Go, go, go-

Juniper, confused, rushes inside. The door closes.

Hazel comes in with Sienna.

She walks to the table, sniffing.

HAZEL
Who the fuck cooked this nasty shit?

Sienna laughs in the lobby.

HAZEL
Louis! Louis!

Louis holds a hand up to Juniper's face, shushing him.

Hazel runs into the second bedroom and starts making out with Sienna.

The walls are thin.

Their clothes rustle. Louis grabs his pair of headphones, places them around Juniper's head. Juniper smiles, nervous. Louis plays some music. Gives Juniper a thumbs-up. Juniper sends one back.

LOUIS
(whispering)
You good?

Juniper nods. Louis pats him on the back- sits on the desk.

Juniper stands up, follows him to it. Louis grabs his notebook and tries to shove it in the drawer, but Juniper grabs it. He begins looking.

Pictures of Louis's old family. Next page. Next.

He sees an old image of him and Louis.

Louis gulps, makes a motion to shut the book. Juniper shuts it, smirking. He leans across the wall.

LOUIS
(whispering)
It's nothing, I just draw sometimes.

JUNIPER
 (smirks)
 Hey, but you're great at cooking.

Louis blushes. Juniper's eyes go wide.

JUNIPER
 I didn't mean it like that. I'm
 sorry.

LOUIS
 Nah nah nah, you're good.

Louis covers his ears.

LOUIS
 Well- study next time?

JUNIPER
 Okay.

LOUIS
 Okay.

Juniper chuckles softly, then leaves through the front door. He runs through the street, away.

But he takes the time to turn and wave to Louis.

Louis smiles, finger in one ear.

30 INT. EVE'S HOME - NIGHT

30

Eve finishes playing to Petunia and Rosaline.

The two girls clap.

Suddenly, the door opens to Ernie.

ERNIE
 (gasps)
 Are these your friends?

PETUNIA
 I'm Petunia!

ROSALINE
 And I'm Rosaline!

PETUNIA
 We're from east, and we just wanted
 to say how awesome Eve's singing is!

ERNIE
 Is that so?

ROSALINE

We'll be out of your shoes, though,
we know you've had a long day.

ERNIE

Don't worry! Take your time!

The girls pack. But the exhaustion in Ernie's voice slips through.

Eve purses her lips and shrugs. She's made friends.

Ernie nods back.

PETUNIA

Bye!

The door closes. Ernie places the food on the table, soft.

EVE

Petunia and Rosaline. In case you
already forgot their names.

ERNIE

(half-chuckles)

Yeah, I kind of forgot their names
as soon as they told me.

Eve and Ernie laugh.

Ernie rushes to the bedroom. But before she closes the door-

EVE

Wait. Um- Petunia forgot her
bluetooth speaker.

ERNIE

Well then give it back to her!

EVE

I will, but-

Eve plays Adeline's music, quietly.

EVE

While you're getting ready for bed,
can you keep the door open? Just
this once.

Ernie nods. She heads inside her room. The music plays in the distance.

Ernie notices Eve's family portrait, hidden.

ERNIE

Uh- Eve?

Eve peeks.

EVE

Shit! I just hid that 'cause I
didn't want them asking about it.

ERNIE

Is it fine to put up?

EVE

Yeah! Sorry!

ERNIE

No, you're good!

Ernie hangs it up on the wall.

She glances at her mother and father, then at Eve vibing.

She hums with her sister.

31 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

31

And as the world buzzes with static at the elections...

An older Louis enters his home.

32 EXT. TALENS - NIGHT

32

And the city goes dark.

CUT TO BLACK.